
INDIA
India–Mauritius: Building Bridges, Shaping Futures

Foreword

Mauritius occupies a distinctive position within the Indian Ocean's economic landscape, combining political stability, a diversified services-oriented economy, and strong connectivity to African, Asian, and international markets. With a population of around 1.3 million people, a well-developed financial services sector, established tourism industry, and growing ambitions in digital services, logistics, renewable energy and the blue economy, the country offers a range of opportunities for international investors and business partners. Its strategic location, modern business environment, and role as a gateway to African markets further strengthen its long-term economic appeal. At the same time, Mauritius faces constraints including its small domestic market, exposure to external economic conditions, limited land availability, and the need to sustain competitiveness in an increasingly demanding global environment. These factors create a landscape in which considerable opportunity exists alongside the need for carefully structured and commercially viable engagement.

India and Mauritius share a long-standing relationship rooted in deep historical, cultural, and people-to-people connections, which has developed into a broad economic and strategic partnership. Bilateral economic engagement has been supported by strong institutional ties, cooperation in financial services, infrastructure, education, technology, healthcare, and capacity building, alongside significant Indian investment and business presence in Mauritius. The India–Mauritius Comprehensive Economic Cooperation and Partnership Agreement (CECPA), which entered into force in 2021, has provided an important framework for expanding trade in goods and services and improving market access. The underlying complementarities remain strong: India's capabilities in pharmaceuticals, information technology, digital public infrastructure, financial services, manufacturing, renewable energy, healthcare, and education align well with Mauritius's ambitions to strengthen its position as a regional financial, logistics, tourism, and technology hub. These complementarities provide a strong foundation for further commercial engagement across both traditional and emerging sectors.

Looking ahead, this paper outlines a practical set of initiatives through which CCI India can support Indian businesses in engaging with Mauritius through sector-specific market intelligence, structured business matchmaking, investment facilitation, and institutional dialogue with relevant Mauritian ministries, agencies, chambers of commerce, and business associations.



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MAURITIUS

> Experience island luxury and diversity, where cultures blend seamlessly.



Introduction

Mauritius is an island nation located in the Indian Ocean, east of Madagascar, with its capital at Port Louis. It is one of Africa's most developed and stable economies and is globally recognized as a successful example of economic diversification.

India and Mauritius share exceptionally strong historical, cultural and economic ties rooted in shared heritage and longstanding people-to-people relations. India maintains a High Commission in Port Louis and Mauritius is considered one of India's closest strategic partners in Africa.

Basic Facts & Population

The capital city of Mauritius is Port Louis. The country follows a parliamentary democratic system and is a member of the African Union, SADC, COMESA and the Commonwealth. Mauritius is widely known as an international financial hub, a tourism destination and a stable investment platform for Africa. It continues to rank among Africa's top countries in terms of business environment and governance indicators.

Mauritius has a population of approximately 1.27 million people as of 2025. It has a diverse multi-ethnic society consisting mainly of people of Indian, African, Chinese and European origin. A majority of the population is of Indian descent, which forms a key cultural link between India and Mauritius. The literacy rate is high and human development indicators are among the best in Africa.

GDP (Gross Domestic Product)

Mauritius has a nominal GDP of approximately US$ 15–17 billion, placing it among the upper-middle-income economies of Africa. The country also enjoys high GDP per capita levels compared to most African nations. Economic growth is mainly driven by services, tourism, financial services, ICT, real estate and manufacturing.



Culture and Heritage

The culture and heritage of Mauritius reflect a vibrant blend of Indian, African, European, and Chinese influences, shaped by its history of migration and colonial rule. This diversity is evident in its languages, religions, festivals, and cuisine, where traditions from Hinduism, Christianity, Islam, and Buddhism coexist harmoniously. Cultural expressions such as sega music and dance showcase African roots, while Indian traditions are seen in festivals like Diwali. Historical sites like Aapravasi Ghat highlight the island's past as a center for indentured labor, making Mauritius a unique example of multicultural heritage and unity.

Trade with India (Bilateral Trade – in Billions)

India is one of Mauritius' most important trading partners. The bilateral trade between India and Mauritius stands at approximately US$ 1.1–1.4 billion annually. India's exports to Mauritius account for roughly US$ 700–900 million, while imports from Mauritius are estimated at around US$ 300–500 million. The trade relationship shows a surplus in India's favour and is further strengthened by deep investment linkages.

Import & Export from India

India exports a wide variety of goods to Mauritius including petroleum products, pharmaceuticals, rice, machinery, iron and steel, automobiles, textiles, chemicals and engineering goods. Refined petroleum products form a major share of Indian exports. On the import side, India imports specialty chemicals, scrap metals, textiles, seafood, processed sugar and small volumes of manufactured goods from Mauritius. Additionally, Mauritius serves more as an investment and financial partner than a raw material export destination.

Culture & Economic Ties with India

India and Mauritius share exceptionally strong civilizational, cultural and emotional bonds. About 70% of Mauritius' population is of Indian origin, and cultural traditions, languages, festivals and religious practices closely reflect Indian heritage. Economically, Mauritius is one of the largest sources of foreign direct investment (FDI) into India due to the long-standing Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement (DTAA) framework. India is also a major development partner for Mauritius, supporting infrastructure projects, capacity building, digital governance, education, healthcare and defense cooperation.



Economy

Mauritius follows a highly diversified and export-oriented economic model. The major sectors include financial services, tourism, textiles and apparel, sugar, ICT services, seafood processing, real estate and port services. The financial services sector acts as a gateway for investments into Africa and India. Tourism is another major pillar, contributing significantly to GDP, foreign exchange earnings and employment. The sugar industry remains important, though its contribution has declined relative to services and manufacturing.

Strategic Importance & Key Observations

Mauritius is one of India's most trusted and strategically important partners in the Indian Ocean Region. Its role as a financial gateway to Africa, strong maritime position, and political stability make it a critical partner for India's economic and security interests. Mauritius offers major opportunities for Indian companies in finance, ICT, tourism, renewable energy, real estate, healthcare and education. The India–Mauritius partnership is not only economic but also strategic, cultural and people-centric, making it one of the strongest bilateral relationships India has in Africa.

1. Mauritius: Economic Profile and Business Environment

1.1 Economic structure

Mauritius transformed itself from a sugar-dependent economy into a diversified services-oriented one. Key pillars include tourism, financial and business services, information and communication technology, textiles and apparel, seafood, real estate, and agro-industry. The economy is small and open, so it is sensitive to external demand, tourism cycles and global financial regulation.

1.2 Governance and institutions

Mauritius is widely regarded as having strong institutions, rule of law, an independent judiciary based on a mix of civil and common-law traditions, and a stable democratic system. It has consistently ranked well in regional indices for ease of doing business, governance and economic freedom. These attributes underpin its role as an international business jurisdiction.

1.3 Global business sector

Mauritius hosts a sizeable global-business sector, including funds, holding companies, trusts, banking and professional services. Following international scrutiny, the jurisdiction strengthened its regulatory framework, emphasised substance requirements and cooperated with international standard-setters. These reforms improved its standing and are central to future cross-border structuring with India.

1.4 Regional memberships and trade access

Mauritius participates in African and Indian Ocean regional groupings and in African continental trade integration, and has preferential access to several markets under various agreements. This gives firms located there potential access to multiple regional markets, subject to rules of origin and each agreement's conditions.

1.5 Business environment summary

Factor	Observation	Implication
Stability	Democratic, predictable	Attractive for long-term investment
Market size	Small domestic market (about 1.3 million people)	Export orientation and regional strategy needed
Costs	Moderate; land and labour constraints	Automation, skills, selective manufacturing
Skills	Educated, multilingual workforce; skills shortages in niches	Training partnerships, talent mobility

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Factor	Observation	Implication
Connectivity	Island location; air and sea dependence	Logistics planning crucial
Climate	Exposure to cyclones and sea-level rise	Resilient infrastructure, insurance, adaptation

1.6 Key import and export baskets

Mauritius imports fuels, food, machinery, vehicles, pharmaceuticals, electronics and consumer goods. Its exports include apparel, seafood, sugar and sugar-related products, jewellery and diamonds, medical and optical devices, and services such as tourism and financial services. India is a significant supplier of petroleum products, pharmaceuticals, vehicles, cereals, textiles and machinery.

2. Strategic Context of India–Mauritius Relations

2.1 Historical and cultural foundations

A large part of Mauritius's population traces its ancestry to Indian indentured labourers who arrived in the nineteenth century, and the heritage of that migration is recognised internationally. Languages, festivals, cuisine, religion and family links connect the two societies. These ties provide a reservoir of trust and familiarity that few commercial relationships enjoy.

2.2 Political and diplomatic partnership

India and Mauritius have maintained close diplomatic relations, regular high-level visits and an extensive record of cooperation agreements. India regards Mauritius as a key partner in its Indian Ocean outlook, while Mauritius values India as a development partner, a major economy and a neighbour in the wider region. Both countries support a rules-based, peaceful and inclusive Indian Ocean.

2.3 Development cooperation

India has supported Mauritius through lines of credit, grants and projects in infrastructure, public transport, health, education, ICT and capacity-building. Landmark projects include urban transport, public buildings and social housing initiatives, as well as training programmes for civil servants, police and professionals. Such cooperation has built goodwill and created demand for Indian goods, services and expertise.

2.4 Maritime and strategic dimensions

Mauritius lies on key sea lanes and has a very large exclusive economic zone relative to its land area.

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